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# Abstract

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This is my humble effort to find out whether or not the diet of श्रीराम included *meat*. In this document, I try to get into the controversial verses from the रामायण and extract the best information out of it. This is a solo-effort so, might not be academically rigorous, however it was really interesting for me to go into.

## Introduction

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The रामायण is an epic and a religious book followed by many people, for whom श्रीराम is much more than a character. This induces a lot of religious pressure of not demeaning श्रीराम's character as it is a question of many people's religion.

Though, having a deep Bhakti towards श्रीराम is good for one's well-being, it can create emotional clashes if the श्रीराम of any book doesn't match the deity they have भक्ति in. I believe भक्ति transcends way above any character of any epic, especially if we are not sure that we are getting the un-interpolated unchanged as-is original version.

For this research, I want to maintain an eye of an outsider alien that has landed in this world, and he is somehow curious about what श्रीराम, as a character from one of the best epics, रामायण ate. I want to consider whatever रामायण we have got now as-a-whole, without marking any part of रामायण as later interpolation.

There are multiple contrasting views in the case of श्रीराम's diet, a person who is a Vaishnavite might have a pre-assumption that श्रीराम could not eat meat; and a person who is a Smarta or Shaiva might not find surprising that श्रीराम's diet included meat. There could be some bias from my side as well; but will try to remain as much objective as possible.

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# Literature Review

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## Analysis

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## Conclusion

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